However, the final column of Table 2.6 suggests that China's hour of currency dominance has not yet arrived: for the moment, the U.S. dollar remains the clear preference of central bank governors worldwide. If one examines only allocated reserves, it is apparent that the share of the U.S. dollar has shrunk somewhat over the nearly two decades covered by Table 2.5, falling from about 68 to 63 percent of the global total, while the percentage of allocated reserves held in the form of the euro, pound, and yen has increased slightly, to 33 percent. As of 2013, the G5 currencies accounted for 96 percent of all allocated foreign exchange holdings, with the currencies of other advanced industrial countries, including Canada, Australia, and Switzerland, making up most of the remainder. As of that date, official foreign central bank holdings of the currencies of any of the BRICS were negligible. Thus, arguments that the monetary dominance of the United States and other Western powers should continue well into the future would seem to have the weight of evidence behind them. Still, it is worth noting that the share of total official reserve assets whose allocation by currency is reported to the IMF has been dropping steadily over time, suggesting that the actual share of the U.S. dollar in total international reserve holdings is increasingly opaque.

TABLE 2.7

Rankings of G7 and BRICS Global Financial Centers

	GFCI 19 2016		GFCI 14 2013		GFCI 1 2007		Xinhua-Dow Jones 2014
BRICS	*Rank*	*Rating*	*Rank*	*Rating*	*Rank*	*Rating*	*Rank*
Hong Kong	4	753	3	759	3	684	5
Shanghai	16	693	16	690	24	576	5
Shenzhen	19	688	27	660	…	…	15
Beijing	23	682	59	598	36	513	9
São Paulo	43	639	38	643	…	…	35
Rio de Janeiro	44	637	31	654	…	…	
Mumbai	42	640	72	570	39	460	24
Moscow	67	611	69	580	45	421	33
Johannesberg	51	628	61	592	…	…	34
G7 Top 5							
London	1	800	1	794	1	756	2
New York	2	792	2	779	2	760	1
Tokyo	5	728	5	720	9	632	3
Paris	32	667	29	656	11	625	7
Frankfurt	18	689	9	702	6	647	8

Xinhua—Dow Jones International Financial Centers Development Index (2014), National Financial Information Center Index Research Institute, Standard and Poor's Dow Jones Index Co. (November 2014). Global Financial Centres Index 19, GFCI no. 14, and GFCI no. 1, Long Finance Z/Yen Group (April 2016).

Table 2.7 shows a final way to conceptualize the importance of the BRICS in global financial markets. It compares two rankings of international financial centers: the first derived from the London investment research organization Z/Yen, which bills itself as a "commercial think tank," and the second a joint project of China's official government news service, the Xinhua News Agency, and the U.S.-based Dow Jones Corporation.[138]The Xinhua-Dow analysis for 2014 ranked Shanghai and Hong Kong as tied for the fifth most important global financial center, an assessment based on judgments about future growth potential, as well as possession of high scores in confidence, capital attraction, financial innovation, and investment attraction ratings, whereas European cities, such Stockholm, Geneva, and Copenhagen, have fallen sharply in the rankings.

Similarly, the Dow Jones Global Financial Centres Index (GFCI) considers major cities in three of the BRICS—China, India, and Brazil—in the top fifty international financial centers, while Johannesburg (ranked 51) and Moscow (ranked 67) lie just outside this charmed circle. Outside the top ten rankings, where the United States and